



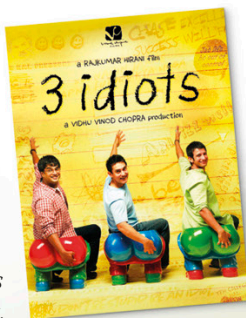
Asia

The Chakra (wheel) is a symbol of the Buddhist faith.

India

Indian movies

India produces more than 1,500 movies a year, in nearly 25 languages. Hindi movies are made in Bollywood and range from comedies (such as *3 Idiots*) to musicals and dramas.



Symbolic hand movements, known as mudras, help tell the story of the dance.

Classical dance

There are many traditional Indian dance forms, each with their own unique costumes, music, and style. This dancer is performing Odissi—an ancient dance from eastern India.

Lakshadweep Islands

Located off India's southwestern coast is this group of 36 coral islands, of which only 10 are inhabited.



0 100 km
0 100 miles
(approximate scale)

0 150 km
0 150 miles
(approximate scale)



The Ganges River (Ganga) flows over a length of 1,616 miles (2,601 km).



Bengal tiger
India's national animal is the endangered Bengal tiger, now protected in nature reserves.

Home to more than **1 billion people**, India is the world's **seventh-largest country** by area. India ranges from the **Himalayas** in the north, to **fertile river** and **coastal plains**, where most people live. A rich variety of **cultures, faiths, and languages** makes India one of the **most diverse nations** on Earth.



- 📏 1,269,219 sq miles (3,287,263 sq km)
- 👤 1.3 billion
- ★ New Delhi
- 🗣️ Hindi, English, other languages (12+)